ago, the earth was made up of a single landmass called *Pangaea* (meaning "all lands"), and a single ocean surrounding it called as Panthalassa. Over a long period of time, probably 220 million years ago, they drifted apart and gradually moved to form their present position. First, Pangaea broke into two landmasses namely Laurasia in the north and Gondwana in the south. Tethys sea was formed between Laurasia and Gondwana.

Laurasia further split into Eurasia and North America. Gondwana land split into Africa, South America, Antarctica, Australia, and India.

Wegener put forward certain evidences to support the continental drift theory. Let us deal with it in detail.

3.3.1 Evidences to support continental drift theory

The continental drift theory is supported by the following evidences.

1. Certain identical rare fossils have been found in different continents.

   The fossils of Mesosaurus (a small Permian reptile), for example, have been found only in Africa and South America.
2. The fossil of a Fern tree, about 360 million year old, has been found only in India and Antarctica.
3. Rocks of similar type, formation, and age have been found in Africa and Brazil.
4. Geological structure in Newfoundland matches with that of Ireland, Scotland and Scandinavia. Geological Structure of Appalachian Mountains matches with Morocco and Algeria in North Africa.
5. The corresponding edges of the continents fit together. For example, the western side of Africa and the eastern side of South America fit together.



'Enchanted rock is a pink' coloured ancient Granite rock located in Texas Which attractes tourists

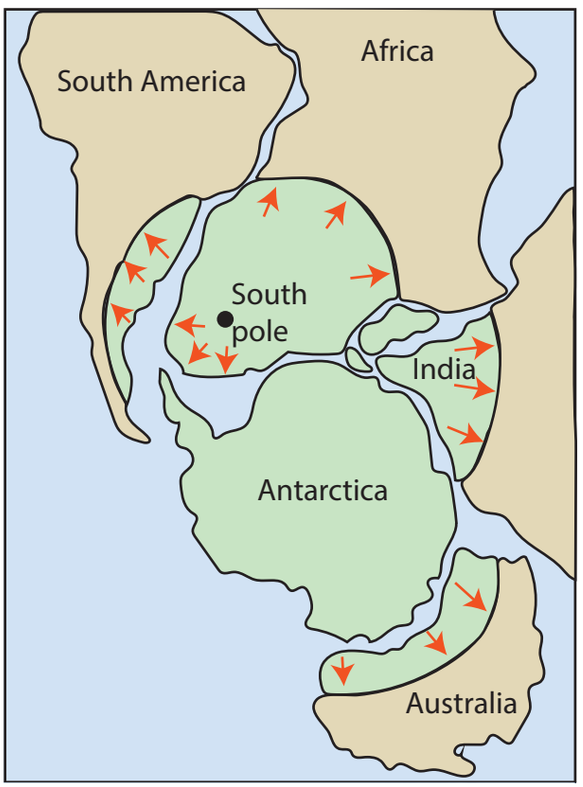


Figure 3.6 Evidence of continents split from the same land mass

3.4 Plate Tectonics

Have you heard about diving between two continents? It is possible in the Silfra rift of Iceland. Look at Figure.3.7. It is located in the Tingvellir National Park. It is in the boundary between the North American plate and the Eurasian plate. It is the visible boundary between these two plates.

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